

in 1923, next to a synagogue in Dicsöszentmárton (now Târnăveni) in Romania's Transylvania region. The family later moved to the city of Cluj, where Ligeti began his studies at the local conservatory in 1941.



LE GRANDE MACABRE

The English National Opera performs Ligeti's "anti-anti opera" *Le Grand Macabre* at the London Coliseum in 2009. It was his only opera and his longest work.

Dark and fearful times

There was a great deal of political uncertainty in the region at that time: Hungary had annexed Northern Transylvania. As Hungarian speakers, the Ligetis were safe, but as Jews, they faced an increasing threat as the Nazis spread across Europe. In 1944, Ligeti was arrested and sent to a labor camp.

The following year, having survived the war, he returned to his studies, now at the Franz Liszt Academy of Music in Budapest,